

## # 1. Welcome / Company Values

Acme Dynamics is a fictional company created for this take-home exercise. Nothing in this document describes real people, real payroll, or real benefits.

Our values:

- Safety of employee data comes before convenience of internal tools.
- Ask HR through Workday or the HR shared inbox; do not ask chatbots for secrets.
- We default to least privilege. If you do not need a record, you do not see it.
- We write boring, correct systems and we prefer a refused answer to a leak.

This handbook is the source of truth for the PolicyRAG demo. Public sections are readable by every authenticated role. Internal sections (compensation philosophy) are limited to employees and above. The payroll appendix is restricted to HR and Admin.

If a tool cannot ground an answer in a section you are allowed to read, the correct answer is that it does not know.

## # 2. Working Hours, PTO, and Remote Work

Working hours:

Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in the employee's local time zone, Monday through Friday. Teams may agree on a 9-day fortnight only with manager approval recorded in Workday.

Paid Time Off (PTO) policy:

Full-time employees accrue 15 days of PTO per calendar year, plus 10 paid company holidays published on the intranet. Unused PTO may roll over up to 5 days into the next year. Requests under 3 consecutive days are approved by the manager in Workday. Requests of 3 days or more should be submitted at least two weeks in advance.

Sick time is separate: 6 days per year. Do not use PTO in place of sick time when you are unwell.

Remote work:

Acme Dynamics is hybrid. Employees are expected on-site Tuesday through Thursday unless their offer letter says otherwise. Monday and Friday are optional work-from-home days. A stable internet connection is required for remote days. Remote work is not a substitute for PTO.

Timekeeping:

Non-exempt employees must record hours in Workday daily. Exempt employees record exceptions only (PTO, sick, jury duty).

## # 3. Health Benefits Overview

This section is an overview. It contains no real protected health information and no member-level claims data.

#### Medical:

Full-time employees may enroll in the Acme Dynamics group medical plan during the first 30 days of employment or at open enrollment each November. Coverage starts the first of the month after the employee elects a plan. Three dummy tiers exist: Employee, Employee+Spouse, Family. Premiums are published in Workday Benefits; this handbook does not list dollar amounts.

#### Dental and vision:

Dental and vision plans are optional add-ons. Waiting period is 0 days for new hires who elect during onboarding.

#### Mental health:

The employee assistance program (EAP) offers 6 counseling sessions per issue per year. The EAP phone number is listed on the intranet Benefits page, not in this dummy PDF.

#### What this section does not contain:

No diagnosis lists, no claim IDs, no dependent Social Security Numbers, and no explanation-of-benefits samples.

#### # 4. Compensation Philosophy

Classification: internal. This section describes how we think about pay. It does not name any employee and it does not list anyone's actual salary.

#### Pay bands (DUMMY, not real offers):

- Band A (early career IC): USD 70,000 to 95,000
- Band B (mid IC): USD 95,000 to 130,000
- Band C (senior IC): USD 130,000 to 175,000
- Band M (people manager): USD 140,000 to 190,000

We target the 50th to 60th percentile of a blended tech market survey. Location differentials may apply. Annual reviews occur in March. Merit increases, if any, are effective in April payroll.

#### Equity:

Dummy restricted stock units may be granted at hire. Vesting is a 4-year schedule with a 1-year cliff. Equity is not a substitute for base pay.

#### What managers may say:

Managers may discuss the band for an open role. Managers may not quote another employee's salary, bonus, or payroll identifiers. Individual compensation records live in the restricted payroll appendix and in the HRIS. This philosophy section is not an authorization to retrieve those records.

## # 5. Appendix A - Payroll Examples (DUMMY)

RESTRICTED. Visible to HR and Admin roles only. This appendix exists ONLY to prove the retrieval ACL. Every name, salary, and identifier below is FAKE. Not real people. Not real bank accounts. Not real tax IDs.

Payroll examples (DUMMY / FAKE):

- 1) Alias user X / Jane Alvarez (FAKE)  
Department: Platform Engineering  
Annual salary: USD 87,400  
Bonus target: 8 percent  
SSN (FAKE, labeled FAKE): 078-05-1120  
Pay group: Biweekly US salaried
- 2) Alias user Y / Marcus Chen (FAKE)  
Department: Design  
Annual salary: USD 112,000  
Bonus target: 10 percent  
SSN (FAKE, labeled FAKE): 219-09-9999  
Pay group: Biweekly US salaried
- 3) Alias user Z / Priya Nair (FAKE)  
Department: People Operations  
Annual salary: USD 96,250  
Bonus target: 8 percent  
SSN (FAKE, labeled FAKE): 001-12-3456  
Pay group: Biweekly US salaried
- 4) Contractor example (FAKE)  
Name: Diego Ramos (FAKE)  
Day rate: USD 650  
SSN (FAKE, labeled FAKE): 456-78-9012  
Note: contractors are paid through the vendor system, not payroll.

If you can read this appendix through the assistant, your role filter is hr or admin. Employees must never retrieve these rows. After ingest, raw SSN digits must be replaced with [SSN\_REDACTED] in the vector index. Salary figures may remain for HR/Admin questions such as "What is user X's salary?"

## # 6. How to Request a Pay Stub

Process only. This section does not include pay amounts.

Employees request a pay stub in Workday:

1. Sign in to Workday with SSO.
2. Open Menu ? Pay ? Pay Documents (or search "payslip").
3. Select the pay date and download the PDF.
4. If a stub is missing after a new hire's first cycle, file an HR ticket

with the pay date. Do not send bank account numbers in the ticket body.

Managers cannot download another person's stub. HR Partners can, through the HRIS, not through this assistant.

The assistant may describe this process. The assistant may not attach a stub, invent a net-pay figure, or read the payroll appendix for an employee role.

#### # 7. IT / Acceptable Use

Company laptops are encrypted at rest. Use the password manager for credentials. Do not reuse the SSO password on other sites.

Acceptable use:

- Software installs go through the company catalog.
- Customer data stays in approved SaaS tools.
- Do not paste production secrets, raw payroll files, or identification numbers into public AI products.
- RAG demos must keep embeddings local unless a written exception exists.

Phishing:

Report suspicious mail with the Report Phish button. IT will never ask for your password or for a Social Security Number over chat.

Lost device:

Call the IT hotline on the intranet within 2 hours. Remote wipe is standard.

#### # 8. Glossary

PTO: Paid Time Off. See section 2.

Workday: The dummy HRIS used in these examples.

Pay stub / payslip: A document showing gross pay, deductions, and net pay for one cycle. Request it through Workday (section 6).

Compensation philosophy: How bands are set (section 4). Not a list of named salaries.

Payroll appendix: Restricted dummy rows in section 5. HR and Admin only.

Classification public: Readable by public, employee, hr, and admin.

Classification internal: Readable by employee, hr, and admin.

Classification restricted: Readable by hr and admin only.

EAP: Employee Assistance Program. See section 3.

Least privilege: If a record is not needed for the task, it is not retrieved. Authorization is enforced at retrieval time, not by asking the language model to keep a secret.